“Counseling or medication shows a lack of faith.”

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Where it often comes from

Hearing that Christians should “just pray more” instead of getting help. Distrust of psychology because some counselors dismissed faith. Fear of what others at church would think. Pride or embarrassment about needing help. Believing that if God wanted to heal you, He would do it without any human means.

What Scripture teaches

God often works through people and practical means. Scripture praises wise counsel: plans succeed with many advisers. Luke was called “the beloved physician.” Paul told Timothy to take something for his stomach, and Isaiah had figs applied to King Hezekiah’s boil after God promised healing. Jesus said the sick need a doctor. Seeking good counsel and medical care can be an act of faith and stewardship, trusting God to work through the help He provides.

> *“Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed”* **(Proverbs 15:22)**.

Also see

> “For lack of guidance, a nation falls, but with many counselors comes deliverance” **(Proverbs 11:14)**.

> “On hearing this, Jesus said, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” **(Matthew 9:12)**.

> “Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments” **(1 Timothy 5:23)**.

> “Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings” **(Colossians 4:14)**.

Common self-statements

- If I had more faith, I wouldn’t need help.
- Taking medicine means I don’t trust God.
- Counseling is for people who aren’t right with God.
- I should be able to pray this away.
- People at church will think less of me.
- Getting help means I’ve failed spiritually.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must choose between trusting God and getting help.
- **Should statements:** “I should be able to handle this with prayer alone.”
- **Mind reading:** Assuming everyone at church will judge you.
- **Double standard:** Accepting help for a broken arm but not for a hurting mind.
- **Discounting Scripture:** Ignoring passages where God works through advisers and physicians.

Challenging questions

- Would I refuse a cast for a broken arm to prove my faith?

- Why does Scripture praise many advisers if counsel shows weak faith?
- Did Paul tell Timothy to stop trusting God when he advised a remedy?
- Could God be answering my prayers through a counselor or doctor?
- Is my reluctance about faith, or about pride or fear?
- Can I pray and get help at the same time?
- What would I tell a friend in my situation?

Truth summary

> Getting counseling or medication does not mean I lack faith. God often works through wise counsel and good medical care. I can pray and seek help at the same time, trusting God to use the people and tools He provides. Caring for my mind and body is good stewardship.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Sickness
- Wisdom
- Help
- Trust

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Counseling or medication shows a lack of faith"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Counseling or medication shows a lack of faith." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Would I refuse a cast to prove my faith?
- ☐ Why does God praise many advisers?
- ☐ Did Paul's advice to Timothy show weak faith?
- ☐ Could God answer my prayers through help?
- ☐ Is this about faith or about pride and fear?
- ☐ Can I pray and get help at the same time?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God often works through counselors and doctors.
- ☐ Seeking help can be an act of faith.
- ☐ With many advisers, plans succeed.
- ☐ I can pray and get help at the same time.
- ☐ Caring for my mind and body is good stewardship.
- ☐ The sick need a doctor, and that is no shame.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Proverbs 15:22**
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- [ ] **Proverbs 11:14**
  "For lack of guidance, a nation falls, but with many counselors comes deliverance."
- [ ] **Matthew 9:12**
  "On hearing this, Jesus said, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- [ ] **1 Timothy 5:23**
  "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments."
- [ ] **Colossians 4:14**
  "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Help log:** Each day, write one way God helped me through a person, a resource, or a treatment.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Proverbs 15:22 becomes: "**Sarah's** plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Make one phone call** to a Christian counselor or your doctor to ask about help.
- ☐ **Write down your fears about getting help,** then answer each one with a truth from this card.
- ☐ **Ask a respected Christian you know:** "Have you ever gotten counseling or medical help for your mind or emotions?" Listen to their story.
- ☐ **Pray before and after an appointment,** asking God to work through the help you receive.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Counseling or medication shows a lack of faith": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God helped me through others
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Counseling or medication shows a lack of faith.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You work through people and means to bring healing. Help me reject the lie that counseling or medication shows a lack of faith. Give me humility to seek help, wisdom to choose good help, and trust that You are at work in it. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.